

B2B SaaS Pricing Architecture

Turning product value into segmentation, packaging, and revenue logic.

COMMERCIAL PROMISE

CATEGORY Pricing Strategy | B2B SaaS Monetization | Commercial UX | Market Research

CONTEXT B2B SaaS company with a 300-400 customer base, flat pricing structure, and underdeveloped expans

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01 | EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Decision-grade strategic readout

\$49/\$149/\$39**9**

three-tier price ladder

35-45%

target ARPU uplift

20-30%

expansion revenue increase

8-12%

trial-to-paid conversion lift

This report redesigns a B2B SaaS pricing model from a one-size-fits-all plan into a segmented commercial architecture. The existing model forced small practices, growing teams, and larger operations into the same value story, suppressing willingness-to-pay capture and weakening upgrade logic. The recommended pricing architecture establishes three tiers, clear feature fences, and an evidence-led validation plan.

CORE THESIS

Pricing is not just a number. It is the commercial architecture that tells each customer which version of the product was built for them, why they should upgrade, and what value they are paying to unlock.

CLIENT VALUE

The redesigned architecture improves buyer clarity, lowers mismatch, gives larger customers a credible enterprise path, and creates a testable route to ARPU and expansion revenue growth without requiring a full product repositioning.

Report orientation

- Segment-first design: customer maturity determines value story and package logic.
- Revenue discipline: feature unlocks, support levels, integrations, and governance are mapped to willingness to pay.
- Validation-first rollout: pricing changes are supported by cohort tests, A/B tests, sales feedback, and churn monitoring.

02 | SCQA STORYLINE

Situation - Complication - Question - Answer

1 Situation

The product serves customers with materially different maturity, usage, support, integration, and governance needs.

2 Complication

A single flat plan forces unlike customers into the same offer: small customers overpay, growing teams lack scale capabilities, and larger accounts are undervalued.

3 Question

How should pricing, packaging, and communication be redesigned so the company captures value without increasing churn risk?

4 Answer

Implement a three-tier architecture - Starter, Growth, Enterprise - aligned to customer maturity, value drivers, feature fences, support levels, and validation metrics.

DECISION PRINCIPLE

Price tiers should reflect real differences in customer value, operating maturity, support cost, and willingness to pay - not arbitrary feature splitting.

Root causes, constraints, and failure modes

The problem is segmentation, not merely price level. A flat model fails to recognize that early adopters want lower friction, growing teams need collaboration and integrations, and larger operations require governance, SLA, support, analytics, and enterprise credibility.

1 Flat value story

The same pricing narrative is used for customers with different use cases, budgets, and maturity levels.

2 Weak upgrade rationale

Buyers do not see a clear commercial reason to move from entry usage to higher-value plans.

3 Enterprise under-packaging

Strategic-account needs such as SLA, security, admin controls, analytics, and custom integrations are not monetized explicitly.

Observed stakeholder friction

Stakeholder	Observed friction	Decision need
Founders / finance	Under-monetization and weak ARPU progression	Plan mix model and validated price points
Product	Unclear feature prioritization for tiers	Feature fences tied to customer maturity
Sales	Inconsistent objection handling	Pricing narrative and enablement guide
Customers	Hard to self-identify the right package	Pricing page organized around buyer logic

04 | FUTURE-STATE RECOMMENDATION

Target model and strategic architecture

RECOMMENDED FUTURE STATE

Move to a three-tier pricing system: Starter at \$49 per user/month for essential adoption, Growth at \$149 for teams scaling operations, and Enterprise at \$399 for advanced governance, integrations, analytics, SLA, and dedicated support. Package the tiers around outcomes, not feature volume.

1 Starter

Entry tier for smaller teams needing core workflow, basic integrations, standard support, and low adoption friction.

2 Growth

Scale tier for growing teams requiring collaboration, higher limits, priority support, and advanced integrations.

3 Enterprise

Premium tier for larger operations needing SLA, security, admin controls, analytics, custom integrations, and dedicated support.

4 Validation system

Run price sensitivity, pricing-page A/B tests, cohort pilots, sales-call review, churn, and upgrade monitoring.

Strategic design choices

- Pricing page structured around customer maturity, not a generic feature checklist.
- Tier cards show target segment, price, primary value promise, and upgrade trigger.
- Green signals highlight growth/scale value; cyan signals clarify decision logic and comparisons.

05 | OPERATING MODEL

Workflow logic and ownership model

The pricing operating model converts customer data, usage signals, product capabilities, and buyer needs into a repeatable monetization system.

Process step	Input	Decision logic	Output	Owner
Segment customer base	Customer size, maturity, usage, support needs	Identify early stage, growing team, or enterprise profile	Segment assignment	Product marketing / revenue
Map value drivers	Use cases, outcomes, risk reduction, scalability	Determine what each segment values most	Value-driver matrix	Strategy / product
Design tier fences	Features, user limits, support, integrations	Create clean upgrade reasons	Starter, Growth, Enterprise packages	Product / pricing
Build pricing page	Tier architecture and buyer logic	Present decision-ready pricing	Pricing UX structure	Design / marketing
Validate performance	Conversion, churn, upgrade, ARPU	Measure pricing impact	Test report and backlog	Revenue operations

OPERATING CONTROL LOGIC

Pricing governance should prevent ad hoc exceptions. Any discount, enterprise exception, or feature unlock should be tracked against segment logic and margin impact.

What changes in the business system

Dimension	Before	After	Business impact
Pricing logic	One flat plan	Segmented tier architecture	Better value capture
Customer fit	Same offer for unlike customers	Package aligned to maturity	Lower friction and better relevance
Expansion path	Weak or unclear	Clear upgrade ladder	Stronger expansion revenue
Enterprise readiness	No dedicated structure	Enterprise tier with SLA, security, and custom integrations	Better strategic-account positioning
Validation	Limited pricing test discipline	Defined test plan and commercial metrics	Safer rollout and measurable improvement

TRANSFORMATION LOGIC

The business moves from charging for access to monetizing maturity. The customer can self-identify; the company can capture expansion value; sales can explain the upgrade path.

Controls that make the recommendation defensible

Pricing changes create real commercial risk. The rollout must manage customer perception, churn, margin, and internal consistency while preserving a clean upgrade path.

Risk	Control
Customer backlash	Grandfathering rules, phased rollout, and proactive communication.
Small-customer churn	Accessible entry tier and usage-aligned value story.
Enterprise under-packaging	Premium tier includes SLA, security, dedicated support, analytics, and integrations.
Confusing pricing page	Simple segment labels and clear feature fences.
Weak validation	A/B testing, cohort analysis, sales feedback, churn, and plan mix monitoring.
Margin erosion	Support and service levels mapped to price tier.
Sales inconsistency	Pricing memo and enablement guide for revenue teams.

GOVERNANCE PRINCIPLE

The pricing system should be managed as a living commercial architecture. Every adjustment should be evaluated against ARPU, conversion, churn, support burden, and expansion revenue.

08 | EXPECTED BUSINESS IMPACT

Metrics, economics, and management value

35-45%

target ARPU uplift

20-30%

expansion revenue increase

8-12%

trial-to-paid conversion improvement

3 tiers

clear commercial ladder

KPI	Projected impact
ARPU uplift	35-45% target uplift through segmented pricing and premium packaging.
Expansion revenue	20-30% increase from clearer upgrade path and enterprise tiering.
Pricing mismatch	Meaningful reduction through segment-specific offers.
Trial-to-paid conversion	8-12% improvement from clearer buyer fit and pricing-page logic.
Churn risk	Lower churn among small customers through accessible entry package.
Sales confidence	Stronger pricing narrative and objection handling.

ECONOMIC READOUT

The monetization upside comes from better fit, not price inflation. The architecture lets the company capture strategic value while reducing friction for smaller customers.

09 | IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

Sequenced plan from diagnosis to scale

Phase	Objective	Key activities	Deliverables	Timeline
1. Diagnosis	Identify mismatch	Analyze usage, churn, support, plan fit, and willingness-to-pay signals	Pricing diagnosis memo	1-2 weeks
2. Segmentation	Define architecture	Build segments, tier fences, value drivers, and price points	Pricing architecture	2 weeks
3. UX / Messaging	Translate logic	Design pricing page, plan comparison, and upgrade narrative	Pricing UX prototype	1-2 weeks
4. Validation	Test assumptions	Run interviews, sales review, A/B test, and cohort modeling	Validation report	2-4 weeks
5. Rollout	Launch and refine	Implement pricing, monitor KPIs, refine packages	Launch dashboard	4-6 weeks

EXECUTION DISCIPLINE

The safest rollout treats pricing as an experiment with governance. Validate buyer comprehension and upgrade behavior before full migration.

10 | PORTFOLIO VALUE

Why this work is commercially credible

This project shows commercial strategy, product judgment, and UX clarity. It diagnoses the revenue problem beneath the surface of pricing and translates it into a segmented growth system with practical validation discipline.

1 Commercial architecture

Links segmentation, value drivers, tier fences, and ARPU progression.

2 Executive clarity

Gives leadership a shared language for plan design and upgrade logic.

3 UX/UI strength

Turns pricing into a self-identification experience for buyers.

4 Revenue discipline

Connects price changes to tests, KPIs, churn risk, and margin controls.

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

Proceed with a controlled three-tier pricing rollout, beginning with pricing-page testing and high-usage customer pilots. Use ARPU, conversion, churn, support load, and upgrade rate as the decision metrics before full migration.